Styles of Anger Assessment

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Everyone has a usual way of handling anger. Each style has a cost, and some do more harm than others. Knowing your default style helps you notice it and choose a calmer, more respectful response.

Score each statement: **3 = Often** **2 = Sometimes** **1 = Rarely** **0 = Never**

Score	#	Statement
	1	When I'm angry, I keep quiet and hope it blows over.
	2	When I'm angry, I raise my voice so people know I mean it.
	3	When I'm upset with someone, I ask to talk it through.
	4	When I'm upset, I drop hints instead of saying what's wrong.
	5	I leave the room rather than deal with someone I'm angry with.
	6	I push until the other person gives in.
	7	I tell people what bothers me and ask how they see it.
	8	I do favors for people so they'll go along with what I want later.
	9	I tell myself my feelings don't matter much.
	10	I say things in anger that I regret later.

Copyright © 2026 WV Adult Basic Education

Score	#	Statement
	11	I stay calm enough to listen, even when I'm frustrated.
	12	I steer the conversation so it ends up where I want it.
	13	I agree just to end an argument.
	14	When I'm angry, I need to win.
	15	I look for a solution that works for both of us.
	16	I complain to other people instead of the person I'm angry with.
	17	I put off dealing with problems that make me angry.
	18	I slam doors, hit things or throw things when I'm mad.
	19	I wait until I've cooled down, then come back to the problem.
	20	I act fine on the outside but find ways to get back at the person.

Scoring

Copy your score for each statement onto its line below, then add up each column. Your highest total is your default style.

Avoidance

1 _____

5 _____

9 _____

13 _____

17 _____

TOTAL _____

Forceful

2 _____

6 _____

10 _____

14 _____

18 _____

TOTAL _____

Collaborative

3 _____

7 _____

11 _____

15 _____

19 _____

TOTAL _____

Indirect Control

4 _____

8 _____

12 _____

16 _____

20 _____

TOTAL _____

Copyright © 2026 WV Adult Basic Education

The Four Styles

Avoidance

Withdrawing, staying quiet, avoiding conflict to keep the peace

IT HELPS

Gives everyone time to cool down.

WATCH OUT FOR

Problems that never get solved, and feelings that build up.

BEST USED WHEN

Things are too heated to talk right now, or the issue is small.

Forceful

Intimidation, overpowering, expressing emotions without filter

IT HELPS

Gets fast action, but through fear.

WATCH OUT FOR

Damaged trust, and people who stop speaking up around you.

BEST USED WHEN

Never as a threat. In an emergency, a short, firm instruction such as “Stop. Step back.” is enough.

Collaborative

Hearing all sides, pursuing resolution constructively, maintaining relationships

IT HELPS

Solves the problem and keeps the relationship.

WATCH OUT FOR

It takes time, and both people have to be willing.

BEST USED WHEN

The relationship and the result both matter.

Indirect Control

Manipulation, maneuvering situations, appearing collaborative but controlling

IT HELPS

Can keep tension from boiling over in the moment.

WATCH OUT FOR

People feel used once they notice, and trust drops.

BEST USED WHEN

Rarely. Say what you want openly instead.

Copyright © 2026 WV Adult Basic Education